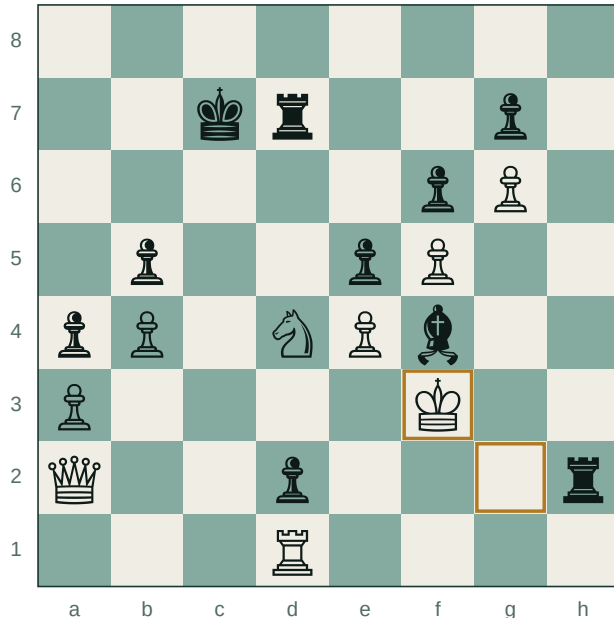


# Loose-piece tactics: Black, move 42

Loose-piece tactics

## Black to move



Previous move: 42.Kf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

## WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

### 42...Rxd4 43. Qf7+ Rd7

**42...Rxd4** The rook captures the knight on d4. Recorded reply: **43.Qf7+**.

**43...Rd7** The rook moves from d4 to d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -3 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A piece may appear hanging because its defender is indirect: taking it might allow mate, a fork, or a stronger capture.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An undefended or tactically undefendable piece can turn an ordinary position into a combination. The first task is to distinguish a truly free capture from a poisoned one.

## HOW TO LOOK

List the loose enemy pieces and check whether a forcing move can expose or attack more than one of them.

The defending king is on f3. Geometrically undefended: knight on d4 and queen on a2. Check for tactical protection.